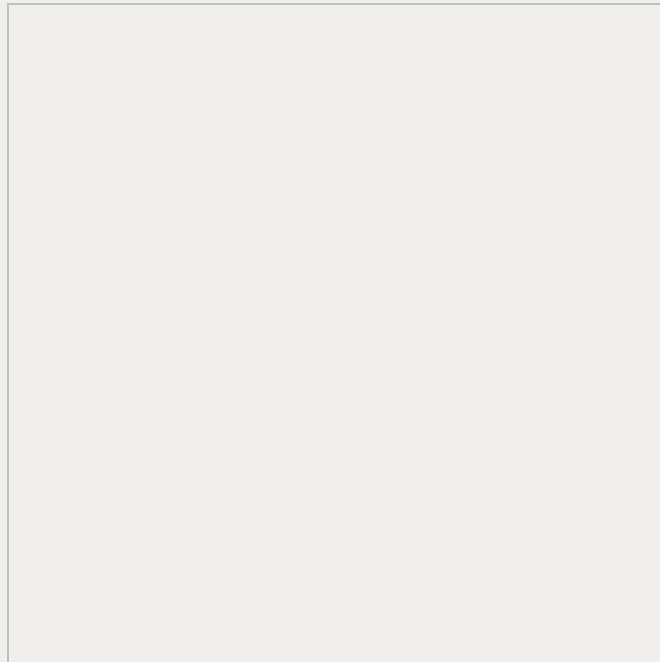


IN CONTEXT

Brazilian nationalism

Brazil gained independence from Portugal in 1822, but Portuguese influence on its culture in the ensuing Empire of Brazil remained strong. Throughout the 19th century, a nationalist movement flourished, asserting a Brazilian identity, as well as true political independence, which involved the integration of indigenous traditions and those brought by African slaves into the largely European colonial culture. This started to become a reality after the establishment of the First Republic in 1889, under which creative artists such as Villa-Lobos forged a Brazilian cultural identity no longer shaped solely by European traditions.



FLAG OF THE REPUBLIC OF BRAZIL